



APPLEGATE
PARTNERSHIP &
WATERSHED COUNCIL

2025 Annual Report

Executive Director
Janelle Dunlevy

Prepared by
Charlotte Hyde
Education & Outreach Program Director

Photo Description. Salvaged logs are placed in Williams Creek at Provolt Recreation Site.

Table of Contents

03 Staff and Board

08 Aquatic Habitat
Restoration

04 Executive
Director Message

09 Riparian &
Upland Habitat
Restoration

05 Program
Overviews

10 Outreach

06 Project Highlight
*Upper Applegate All-Lands
Wildfire Resiliency Project*

11 Education

07 Wildfire Risk
Reduction

12 Financial
Overview

Photo Description. Applegate Outdoor School staff prepare for a program day by collecting macroinvertebrates in Williams Creek.



STAFF AND BOARD

Board of Directors

Jack Shipley
Emeritus Board Member

David Russell
Board Chair

Janis Mohr-Tipton
Board Vice Chair

Barbara Summerhawk
Secretary & Treasurer

Geoff Becker
Executive Board Member

Kirsten Shockey
Executive Board Member

Mary Buckley-Mikkelsen
Mark Hamlin
Alan Journet
Heidi Martins
Chas Rogers
Mel Wann

Staff Members

Janelle Dunlevy
Executive Director

Caleb Galloway
Riparian Restoration Project Manager

Nathan Gehres
Resilient Landscape Project Manager

Charlotte Hyde
Education & Outreach Program Director

Eva King
Education Manager

Aaron Krikava
Fire Adapted Community Educator

Michelle Kuzma
Finance & Operations Manager

Luke Wimmer
Aquatic Restoration Program Director

A MESSAGE FROM THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

The scope of the Applegate Partnership & Watershed Council's activity in 2025 is a testament to our growth as an organization and to our commitment to the Applegate Valley community.

In a year that has presented a range of challenges to non-profit organizations all over, we have been lucky to forge ahead with new and existing projects due to our diverse funding sources, strong partnerships, and community support. Each program has exhibited growth.

Our Wildfire Risk Reduction Program brought in an additional \$2 million in funding for fuels reduction work, the vast majority of which will flow out into the community through contracted services. Our Aquatic Habitat Restoration Program made progress toward six different fish passage and habitat restoration projects. Our Education Program piloted an outdoor summer camp that was enthusiastically received by families across the Applegate.



This growth was made possible through collaborations with landowners, local organizations, government entities, and supportive community members. As we weather the economic and ecological challenges faced by the Applegate Valley and beyond, we are dedicated to nurturing these partnerships as we strive to meet the needs of our community.

Sincerely,
Janelle Dunlevy
Executive Director

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Janelle Dunlevy".

Aquatic  <i>7 Active Projects</i> 80+ Woody Structures Installed	Education  <i>4 Active Projects</i> 650 Students Reached Over 60 Program Days	Wildfire Risk Reduction  <i>3 Active Projects</i> 185 Acres of Fuels Treated
Outreach  <i>30 Events</i> 900 Provolt Volunteer Team Hours	Riparian & Upland  <i>4 Active Projects</i> 173 Acres of Blackberry Treated	Projects by County 8 Projects in Josephine County 6 Projects in Jackson County 4 Projects in Both Counties

PROGRAM OVERVIEWS

Each of APWC's five programs: Aquatic Habitat Restoration, Education, Wildfire Risk Reduction, Outreach, and Riparian & Upland Habitat Restoration, has made significant progress in the last year. Program leaders have completed projects, begun new ones, found funds to continue ongoing projects, and overall, deepened APWCs presence in the Applegate Valley Community.

Project Spotlight

UPPER APPLGATE ALL-LANDS WILDFIRE RESILIENCY PROJECT

Over the past two years, the Upper Applegate All-Lands Wildfire Resiliency Project (UAAWRP) has supported private landowners across the Applegate Valley with wildfire risk mitigation through mechanical fuels treatments. This project was borne out of funding from the Oregon Department of Forestry Small Forestland Grant and has been supplemented with additional funding from a United States Forest Service Sustainable Northwest Grant.

To date, 185 acres have been treated for fuels, with 822 hazard trees removed and processed, and efforts will continue in 2026. As the result of a request for proposal period, fuels reduction management company BurnBot has been selected to carry out treatments going forward. This project represents how landowner outreach and engagement can lead to partnerships that create landscape-level wildfire risk reduction.



Photo Description. The 2024 Upper Applegate Fire.

WILDFIRE RISK REDUCTION

PROJECTS IN PROGRESS

5

*CWPP
Community
Meetings*

Upper Applegate All-Lands Wildfire Resiliency Project (UAAWRP)

See project highlight, page 6.

6

*Live Fire
Understory
Burn
Trainings*

Applegate Valley Community Wildfire Protection Plan Update (CWPP)

A collaborative, community-driven effort to update a document that will guide wildfire preparedness and resiliency in the Applegate Valley. Estimated completion Fall 2026.

185

*Acres of Fuels
Treated*

Rogue Valley Prescribed Burn Association Program Support (RVPBA)

Ongoing sponsorship of RVPBA activities, including pile burning workshops, prescribed burn trainings, and other education and outreach efforts related to community wildfire resiliency.

822

*Hazard Trees
Processed*

Photo Descriptions. **Left:** Trainees participate in a live fire understory burn with RVPBA partners. **Center:** Community members gather at the first round of CWPP meetings in Ruch. **Right:** The 6/18/25 Upper Applegate Fire. Photo by Brian Mulhollen.



Funders and Partners

Applegate Fire District · A Greater Applegate · US Bureau of Land Management · BurnBot · Friends of the Greensprings · Illinois Valley Fire Resiliency Oversight Group · Native Women Share · National Resource Conservation Service · The Nature Conservancy · Northwest Youth Corps · Oregon Department of Forestry · OSU Extension Service · Pacifica · Siskiyou Field Institute · Southern Oregon Forest Collaborative · Sustainable Northwest · Vibrant Planet

AQUATIC RESTORATION



IRRIGATION EFFICIENCY PROJECTS



Mid-Applegate Irrigator Outreach

This project, currently in its planning phase, will result in a technical assistance design for irrigation efficiency in an Applegate ditch.

FISH PASSAGE PROJECTS

Cheney Creek Tributary
Culvert Placement
Completed October 2025



Provolt Recreation Site Large
Woody Debris Placement
Instream Work Completed 2025



Laurel Hill Fish Passage
Design
Estimated completion spring 2026



Cheney Creek Box Culvert
Design
Estimated completion December 2026



Iron Creek Fish Passage
Design
Estimated completion December 2026



Applegate River Mile 25
Side Channel Design
Estimated completion January 2027

Photo Descriptions. Above: An aquatic species-friendly culvert is installed on a Cheney Creek tributary. Below: Woody debris is salvaged and placed in Williams Creek at Provolt Recreation Site.



Funders and Partners

Benchwood LLC · US Bureau of Land Management · Josephine County Public Works · Kubli Ditch Water Users · Laurel Hill Ditch Association · M&M Services LLC · Oregon Department of Fish and Wildlife · Oregon Water Resources Department · Rogue Basin Partnership · Stream & Civil Engineering · Waterways Consulting · Wolf Water Resources · Middle Rogue Steelheaders

RIPARIAN AND UPLAND HABITAT RESTORATION

Provolt Recreation Site Invasive Noxious Weed Removal

Ongoing mechanical removal of Himalayan blackberry and other noxious weeds. All sites have been treated multiple times to minimize regrowth.

Cantrall Buckley Park Vegetative Management and Improvement

Ongoing mechanical removal of Himalayan blackberry and other noxious weeds. Throughout the year, 35 debris piles were created and removed from the park.

Williams Creek Dyer's Woad Treatment

Ongoing hand-pulling of dyer's woad. At this time, all plants have been removed. The sites will continue to be monitored and treated as needed.

Ruch Invasive Plants Treatment

Ongoing hand-pulling of invasive plants and noxious weeds on a private property in Ruch. Target plants include Scotch thistle, common bugloss and yellow toadflax,

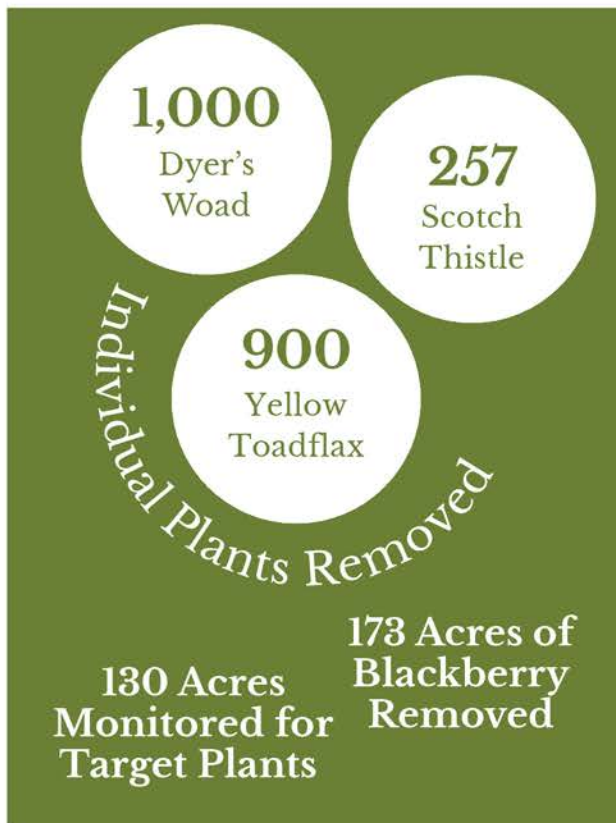


Photo Description. Scotch thistle removed from a property in Ruch.

Funders and Partners

US Bureau of Land Management · Oregon Watershed Enhancement Board · Oregon Department of Agriculture · Williams Creek Watershed Council · Provolt Volunteer Team

OUTREACH



GROUPS

Applegate After Dark

A new group of dark sky enthusiasts who educate on the importance of dark sky preservation and dark sky-friendly practices.

Provolt Volunteer Team

A dedicated team of locals who steward Provolt Recreation Site by operating the gate, maintaining trails, removing noxious weeds, and organizing work parties.

Cantrall Buckley Park Enhancement Committee

A core group of volunteers who take care of Cantrall Buckley Park through trail maintenance, native plantings, and cultural projects.

COMMUNITY EVENTS

All Things Fire Fair

Applegate After Dark's "The Twilight Zone: Bugs, Bats, and Beyond"

3rd Annual Cantrall Buckley Park Celebration

15 Applegate Evening Markets

5 Community Wildfire Protection Plan Public Meetings

MLK Day of Service at PRS

5 Williams Farmer's Markets

World Migratory Bird Day

Photo Description. BLM Wildlife Biologist Zia Fukuda presents on bats at Applegate After Dark's "Twilight Zone" event. Photo: Liz Shen.



Partners A Greater Applegate · US Bureau of Land Management · Pollinator Project Rogue Valley

EDUCATION

Applegate
Outdoor
School (AOS)

Spring

Throughout April, AOS served **350 6th-graders** from Hedrick Middle School in four-day sessions of inquiry-based learning at Cantrall Buckley Park. This year, AOS piloted a High School Leadership Program with support from a UCAN AmeriCorps Environmental Education Specialist.



Applegate
Outdoor
Summer Camp
(AOSC)

Summer

AOSC's pilot season took place in June and July. The program received 99 registrations over four weeks, serving **50 total children**, with an average of **23 campers per week**. AOSC was warmly received by the community, who cited the need for an affordable day camp in the Applegate.



Grow Youth
Program
(GY)

Fall

Grow Youth engaged **230 students** from grades 4-12 over **26 field trips** between September and November. Students came from 5 public schools and 2 homeschool groups. Classes attended between one and five field trips. This year's curriculum focused on local environmental issues.



Applegate
Stewards (AS)

Education staff provided instructional support to Ruch Outdoor Community School's Applegate Stewards class throughout 2025. Students conducted service learning at Cantrall Buckley Park and designed an interpretive sign to be installed at the park.

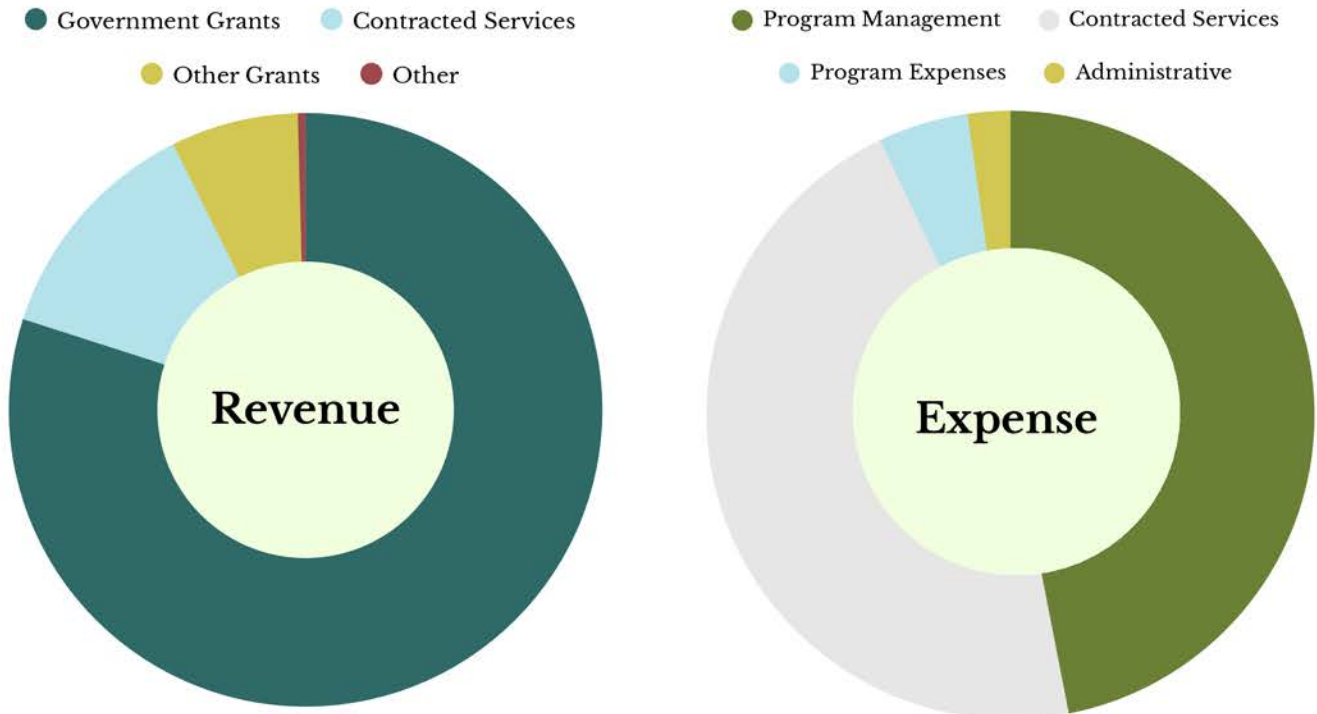
Photo descriptions.
Top: Hedrick Middle School 6th grader collects macroinvertebrates.
Middle: AOSC Camper prepares a craft project.
Bottom: Jacksonville Elementary 4th graders remove invasive star thistle.

Funders and Partners

US Bureau of Land Management · Jackson County Parks
· The Pacific Power Foundation · The Roundhouse
Foundation · Ruch Outdoor Community School · Oregon
State University Extension Service



FINANCIAL OVERVIEW



Revenue

Government Grants	\$957,900	80.00%
Services	\$152,000	12.70%
Other Grants	\$83,200	6.90%
Other	\$5,000	0.40%
Revenue Total	\$1,198,100	100.00%

**Net
Revenue:
\$50,500**

*All revenue is
re-invested into
our programs.*

Expense

Program Management	\$538,600	46.90%
Contracted Services	\$528,100	46.00%
Program Expenses	\$54,900	4.80%
Administrative	\$26,000	2.30%
Expense Total	\$1,147,600	100.00%

Applegate Partnership & Watershed Council

P.O. Box 899 | Jacksonville, OR 97530

(541) 899-9982 | contact@apwc.info

 applegatepartnership.org

 [applegatepartnership](https://www.instagram.com/applegatepartnership)



Photo Description. Salvaged logs are placed in Williams Creek at Provolt Recreation Site.

*03 Award Tracker ▾

[Integrate](#)[Automate / 11](#)

JR

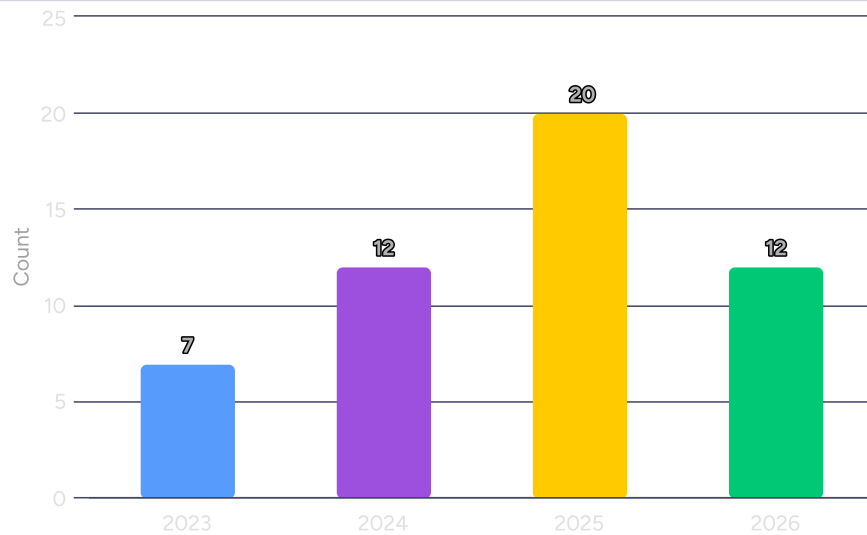
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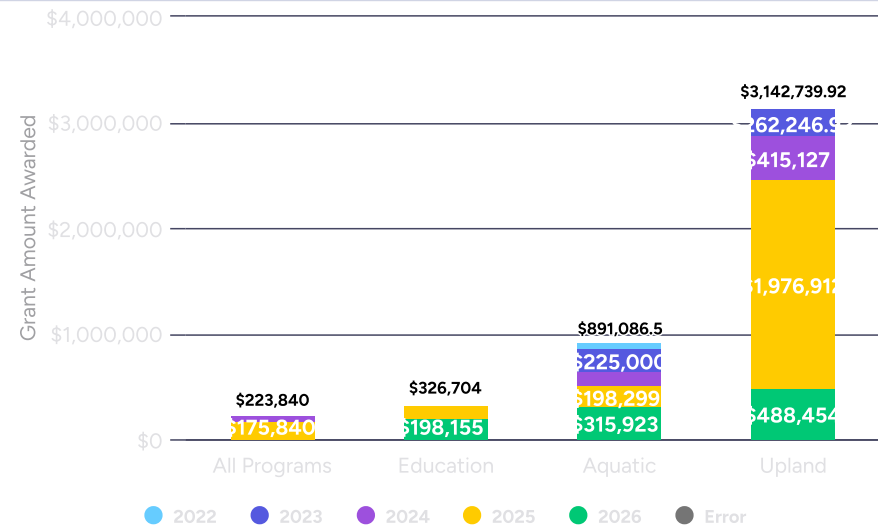
New funding source

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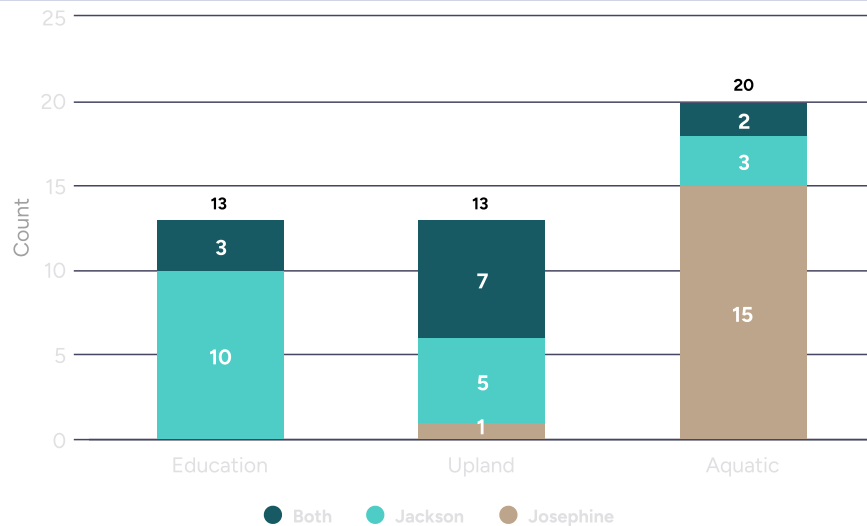
Number of Grants Awarded by Year ▾



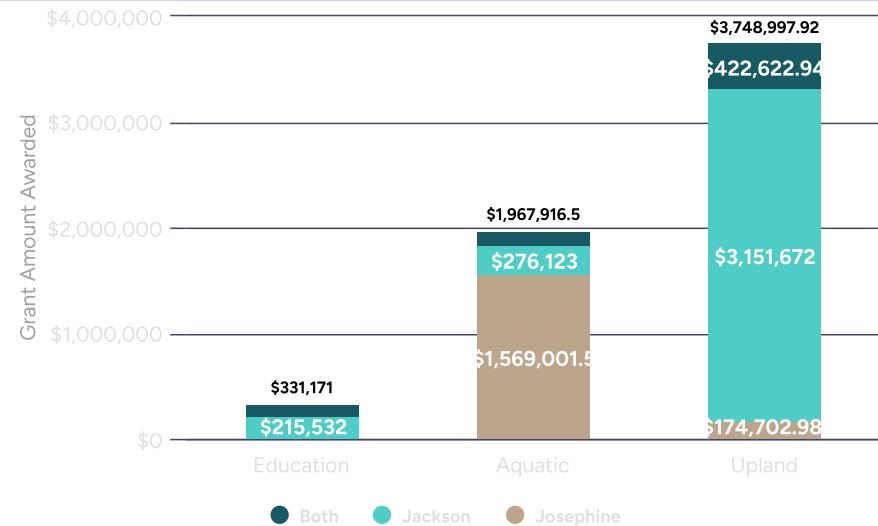
Total Amount Awarded by Program & Year ▾



Number of Awards by Program & County Since Jan-... ▾

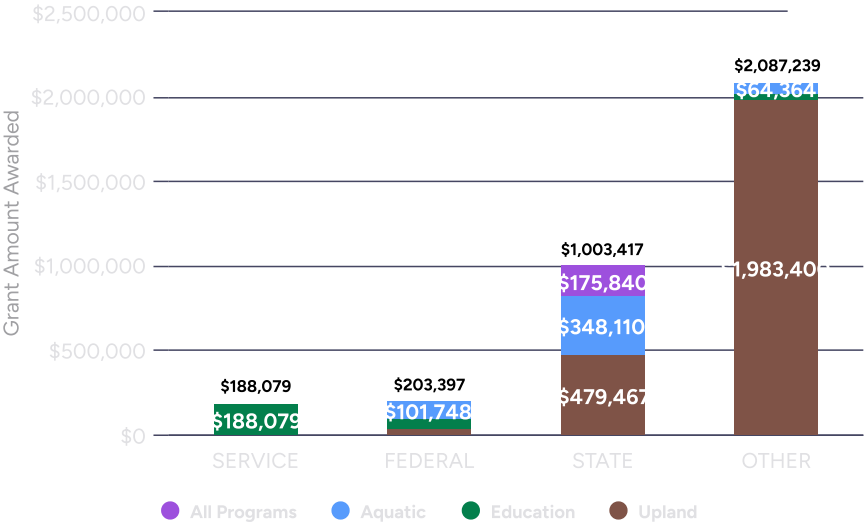


Value of Grants by Program & County since 2023 ▾



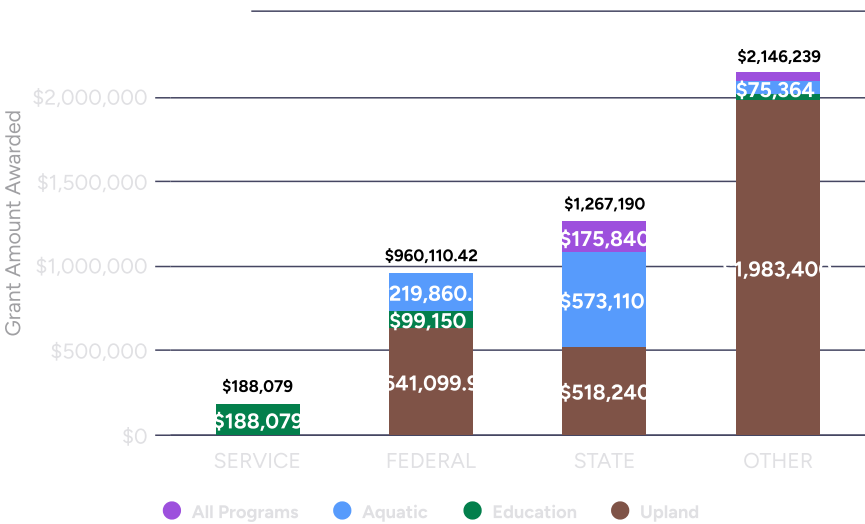
Value of Awarded Grants by Program & Funding Typ...

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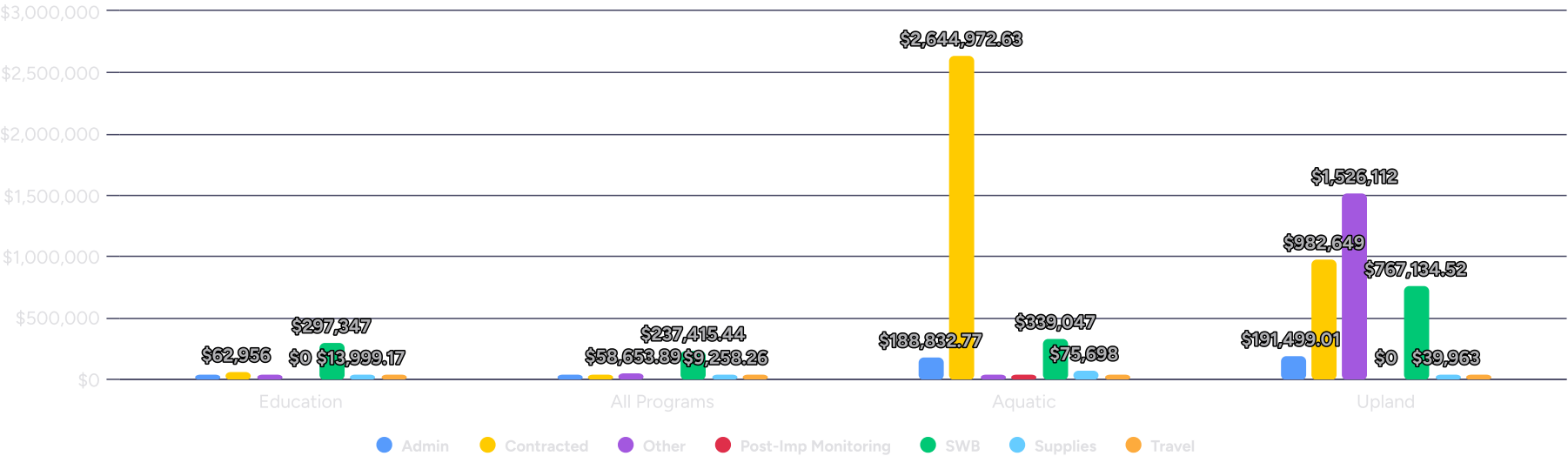
Value of Awarded Grants by Program & Funding Typ...

Filter icon



Budget Category Expenditures by Program

Filter icon



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APPLEGATE UPDATES

WINTER 2026

A missive from the Applegate Partnership & Watershed Council

APWC has hit the ground running in 2026! Read on for project progress across each of our programs.



Reconnecting a Historic Side Channel on the Applegate River

This winter, APWC is starting work on the Applegate River Mile 25 Side Channel Restoration Project near Applegate, Oregon. The project will restore ~0.65 miles of side channel on private properties along the river.

Side channels are smaller channels that branch off from a river and are important habitat for juvenile salmon. They provide slower water, refuge during high flows, and areas where young fish can feed and grow. Since construction of Applegate Dam, much of this off-channel rearing habitat has been eliminated in our watershed.

Like many of our restoration projects, this work will

take place within a river floodway and requires surveying and hydraulic modeling and goes through multiple levels of permitting. Professional designs help us understand how the river will respond during high flows and changing conditions. Design work will continue through 2026, with a goal of construction in 2027.

Good news from Cheney Creek

For the past three winters, APWC has partnered with a fisheries biologist to conduct spawning surveys on Cheney Creek. These surveys track adult salmon and count redds, the nests female salmon create in stream gravel to lay their eggs.

This winter brought especially encouraging results. Redd counts jumped from 16 last year to 116 this winter, more than six times higher than the previous season. Adult observations also increased dramatically, rising from 11 to 44, roughly four times as many adults as last year. Despite relatively low stream flows this season, Cheney Creek saw a strong surge in spawning activity.

Spawning surveys are one way we measure how fish populations are responding to habitat conditions over time. While ocean cycles and other factors influence annual returns, this strong increase is a promising sign for the watershed.

The next challenge for these young fish will be surviving the low flows and warm temperatures of a Southern Oregon summer so they can grow strong enough to begin their journey to the ocean.



Community Wildfire Protection Plan

The second round of Community Wildfire Protection Plan (CWPP) public meetings took place last month in Ruch, Applegate, Williams, Murphy, and Wilderville. APWC and partners presented maps of potential fuels treatment areas based on responses from the CWPP public survey and analysis from the Vibrant Planet decision-making tool. The third and final round of public meetings will be held in April and early May. The goal of those meetings will be to present the draft CWPP document to residents, before it is sent off for editing in early summer.

[Take the CWPP Survey](#)

Fuels reduction work expands

Fuels treatment implementation funded by the recently secured US Forest Service IRA grant is progressing quickly, with impressive results. BurnBot was selected as the contractor and they have met or exceeded all expectations. APWC also obtained two Oregon Department of Forestry Small Forestland Grants to expand the UAAWRP footprint, support local Firewise Communities, and to begin a pilot study on the best practices and costs associated with Douglas Fir mortality mitigation.



Cantrall Buckley Park cleanup

APWC will be conducting cleanup work at Cantrall Buckley Park throughout the winter, following the felling of hazard trees by Jackson County Parks. This work is helping to make the park a safer and more enjoyable place of recreation for our community.



The Education Program continues to grow

APWC's Education Program is getting ready for a packed spring and summer!

First up is Applegate Outdoor School (AOS). We will be hosting 580 6th graders from the Medford School District over eight weeks in April and May. Each 6th grader will experience a week of outdoor, inquiry-based learning at Cantrall Buckley Park.

Next, we are excited to announce that Applegate Outdoor Summer Camp (AOSC) will be returning this summer! Registration for our six-week season opens March 16th.

[Learn About AOSC](#)

We are seeking community contributions to the AOSC Scholarship Fund. Donations will allow campers from qualifying families to attend camp at a reduced rate.

We are also gathering AOSC Program Sponsorships to support overhead costs and support the program's sustainability.

[Give to AOSC](#)



Upcoming events abound

Mark your calendars! Our spring events lineup is packed with opportunities to get your hands dirty, learn about local flora and fauna, marvel at the stars, and connect with the community about wildfire resiliency efforts.

Upcoming events include:

- **Provolt Rec Site Volunteer Work Parties** with the Provolt Volunteer Team - February 27th, March 27th, and April 25th
 - **3rd Annual All Things Fire Fair**, hosted by A Greater Applegate - March 6th/7th
 - **Stargaze at Wooldridge Creek Winery** with Applegate After Dark - March 20th
 - **Guided Hike of Provolt Rec Site** with APWC's very own Riparian Restoration Project Manager, Caleb Galloway - April 24th
- 4th Annual Applegate Valley Community Celebration**, hosted by Janis Mohr-Tipton - April 25th

[Event Details](#)

WINTER 2026

Applegate Partnership and Watershed Council, 60 Upper Applegate Rd, Jacksonville, United States

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[Unsubscribe](#)



THE APPLGATE COMMUNITY WILDFIRE PROTECTION PLAN (CWPP)

One plan to guide
wildfire preparedness
and resilience in the
Applegate Valley.

The Applegate community created the first Community Wildfire Protection Plan in the nation in 2002. Conditions have changed significantly in the past quarter century. Our population has grown, with more people than ever living in the woods or Wildland Urban Interface (WUI). The Applegate Partnership & Watershed Council (APWC) has secured funding to update the CWPP, and we will be working with the residents of the Applegate to make sure that the new document meets the needs of today.

What is a CWPP?

A plan developed by a community at risk of wildfire. The Community Wildfire Protection Plan development process is a collaboration between communities and agencies interested in reducing wildfire risk.



Scan to learn more.



For more information,
contact Nathan Gehres at
nathan@apwc.info

The CWPP will contain:

Planning and
prioritization of
activities to
reduce wildfire
risk

Coordination of
residents and
firefighting
resources during a
wildfire event

Recovery plans
after a wildfire or
other emergency
impacts our
community.

APPLEGATE COMMUNITY WILDFIRE PROTECTION PLAN (CWPP)

*One plan to guide wildfire
preparedness and resilience
in the Applegate Valley.*



<https://applegatepartnership.org/cwpp>

FINAL ROUND OF COMMUNITY MEETINGS

All Meetings 6-8pm

Community	Date	Location
Wilderville	April 16th	Apricity Vineyard 5719 Jerome Prairie Rd, Grants Pass
Murphy	April 21st	Hidden Valley High School 651 Murphy Creek Rd, Grants Pass
Applegate	April 27th	Applegate Community Church 18960 N Applegate Rd, Grants Pass
Ruch	April 29th	Applegate Valley Fire Dist. #9 Training Building 1095 Upper Applegate Rd, Jacksonville
Williams	May 7th	The Williams Grange 20100 Williams Hwy, Williams



We want your input! Scan the code or follow the link to take the CWPP Public Survey. The survey is open until April 1st.

<https://tinyurl.com/avcwppsurvey>